Wenni Yang

Citizenship: Chinese (U.S. permanent residency pending)
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Research Fields

Primary fields: Labor Economics, Health Economics **Secondary fields**: Economics of Education, Economic History

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California, Davis *2021–June 2027 (expected)*
M.A. in Economics, Fudan University, Shanghai *2021*
Exchange Student in Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam *2019*
B.A. in Economics (Insurance Specialization), East China Normal University, Shanghai *2018*

Publications

"Congestion on the Information Superhighway: Inefficiencies in Economics Working Papers" with Lester R. Lusher and Scott E. Carrell. *Journal of Public Economics*, Volume 225, 2023. [published link] [ungated] [NBER WP29153]

Working Papers

Job Market Paper

"Doctors With(out) Borders: Effects of Easing Occupational Licensing for Foreign-trained Physicians"
Newly digitized state licensure records · AMA physician directories, individuals linked across years · County-level AHA hospital and NCHS mortality data · Staggered DiD across state reform dates

"The Effects of Marriage Bar: Evidence from US Teachers in 1900–1940," with Rebecca Brough
Hand-collected marriage bar adoption and repeal, U.S. city school boards · Newspapers and journals · 1880–1940 Census · Staggered DiD across city-level adoption timing

"Cash for Class: The Effect of Paying Students for Full-Time Community College Enrollment," with Paco Martorell, Scott E. Carrell, Elizabeth Friedmann, and Alice Li
Student-level linkage across large administrative datasets · Regression discontinuity at an income eligibility threshold

"Effects of Financial Aid Expansion for Community College Adult Learners," with Oded Gurantz, Michal Kurlaender, Elizabeth Friedmann, and Paco Martorell. *Revise and Resubmit.*
Two-way fixed effects DiD between eligibility groups and recipient cohorts

Works in Progress

"Competition Without Entry: Evidence from California's 1961 DO–MD Merger"

"Addressing OCR Failures in Economic History: An Agentic AI Approach," with Joshua Barnett

"Long-run Health Impact of Accessing Licensed Physicians"

Fellowships and Awards

Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant *2026*
Dean's Summer Graduate Support Award *2026*
ASHEcon Diversity Scholarship *2026*
UC President's Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting Fellowship *2025*
Research Grants (×4), UC Davis Economics Department *2023–2026*

External Conference Presentations

2026: Becker Friedman Institute Health Economics Initiative Conference, ASHEcon, ASSA
2025: Economic History Association Meeting, Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting in Economics Science

Teaching

University of California, Davis
- Project Manager, Undergraduate Research Fellow Program (15+ students) — *2024, 2025*
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 001A: Introductory Microeconomics — *2021, 2022, 2025*

Fudan University
- Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Economics — *2021*
- Teaching Assistant, Industrial Organization — *2020*
- Teaching Assistant, Health Economics and Policy — *2019*

Employment

- Research Assistant for Professors Scott Carrell and Paco Martorell, UC Davis — *2022–2026*
- Research Assistant for Professor Sharon Xuejing Zuo, Fudan University — *2021*
- Mergers & Acquisitions Intern, Fosun International, Shanghai — *Dec. 2020–May 2021*
- Research Assistant for Professor Laura Hering, Erasmus University of Rotterdam — *2020*

Service and Leadership

- Referee: *Economic Inquiry* — *2026*
- Discussant (×2): Global Migration Center Student Seminar, UC Davis — *2025*
- Co-organizer: Applied Micro Student Talk, UC Davis — *2023–2025*
- Head Organizer: Gender Economics Reading Group (15+ students), UC Davis — *2021–2022*

Other Skills

Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, MATLAB, LaTeX
Data: Large-scale administrative data; historical data digitization (OCR / LLM-assisted extraction) of AMA physician directories and state licensure records; record linkage and fuzzy matching
Language: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

References

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